

NEEL

PENNYVALE

SILVERBERG

THE LAST ARCHIVIST

• SHADOWS OF THE FROZEN MANOR •



PENNYVALE

COMICS

VOL. 1



MORE
DOORS.

ZERO
LOGIC.

THIS PLACE IS
NOT BUILT TO
BE UNDERSTOOD.



THEN IT'S
BUILT TO
TEST.



SOMEWHERE
IN THIS MADNESS,
THERE'S A DOOR
THAT STAYS
OPEN.



UPSIDE DOWN.
SIDWAYS.
BACKWARDS.

DOESN'T
MATTER.
WE KEEP
MOVING.



MY HAND
REMINDS ME—
SOME THINGS
CANNOT BE
RUSHED.



WE FIND THE
RIGHT DOOR.
TOGETHER.





THIS PLACE...
IT SHOULDN'T
EXIST.

YET HERE
IT STANDS.



NO LUXURY.

NO PRETENSE.

ONLY CARE.

ONLY INTENT.



EVEN THE
FLAME IS
FROZEN...

AS IF TIME
ITSELF HOLDS
ITS BREATH.



EVERY LINE.
EVERY WEAVE.
EVERY JOINED
PIECE OF WOOD...

SOMEONE
MADE THIS
BY HAND.

NOT FOR
GLORY.

NOT FOR
WEALTH.

BUT FOR
LIFE.



HOW
RARE.



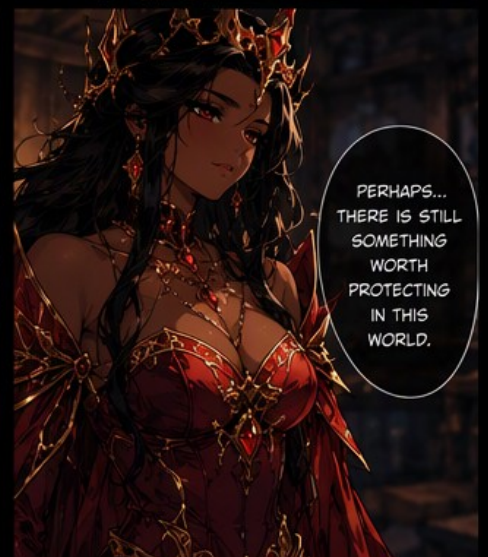
IN MY WORLD,
EVERYTHING
IS BUILT TO
ENDURE...

NOTHING
IS BUILT TO
BELONG.



A SINGLE
FROZEN
FLAME...

YET IT WARMS
MORE THAN
A THOUSAND
THRONES.



PERHAPS...
THERE IS STILL
SOMETHING
WORTH
PROTECTING
IN THIS
WORLD.



THE FINAL
DOOR.

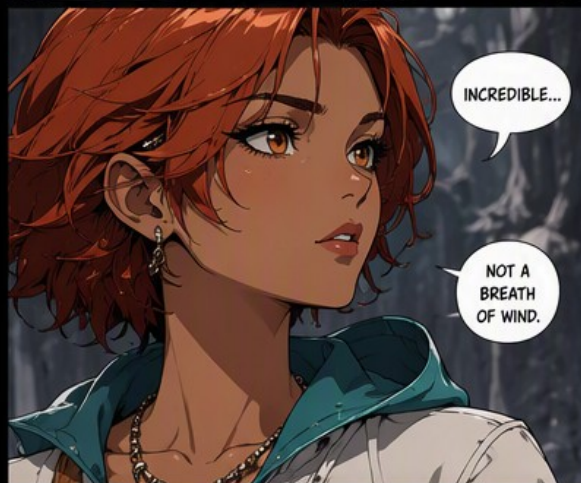
PAST THIS,
THERE'S NO
TURNING BACK.

THEN LET'S
SEE WHAT WE'VE
BEEN CHASING.

...A FOREST.



GROWN
WITHIN THESE
WALLS.



INCREDIBLE...

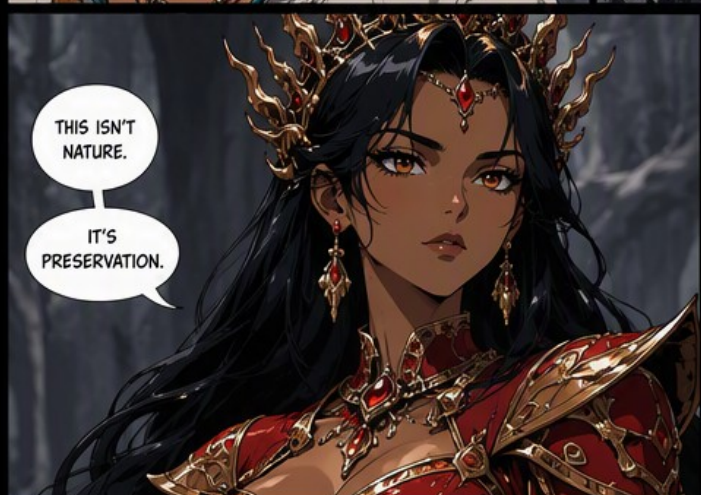
NOT A
BREATH
OF WIND.



NOT A
SINGLE LEAF
OUT OF PLACE.

EVERYTHING
HERE...

...IS
HOLDING ITS
BREATH.



THIS ISN'T
NATURE.

IT'S
PRESERVATION.



SOMETHING
LIVES HERE.

BUT IT HASN'T
BEEN ALLOWED
TO MOVE.



A SINGLE FEATHER
DRIFTS DOWN...



THROUGH STILLNESS.



IT SETTLES WITHOUT
A SOUND.



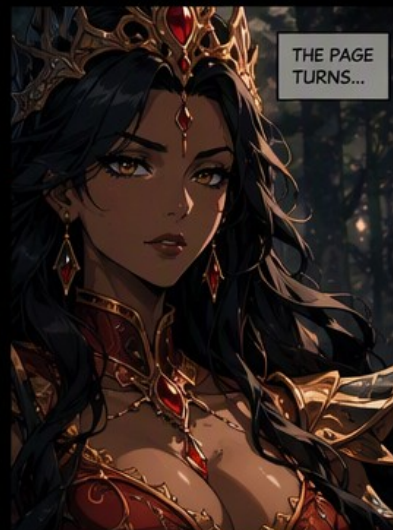
A DEEP CLAWED
INDENTATION.



NOT HUMAN.

NOT SIMPLE.

SOMETHING
LARGE. SOMETHING
POWERFUL.



THE PAGE
TURNS...



...SOMEWHERE
AMONG THE
TRUNKS.

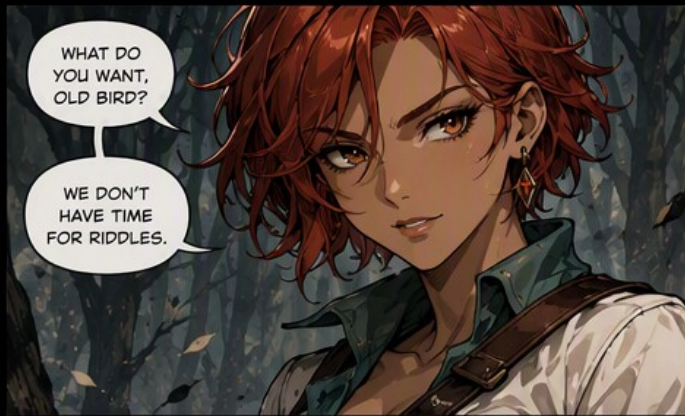


THE ARCHIVIST.

I WAS WONDERING WHEN YOU'D SHOW YOURSELF.



YOU ALWAYS DO.



WHAT DO YOU WANT, OLD BIRD?

WE DON'T HAVE TIME FOR RIDDLES.



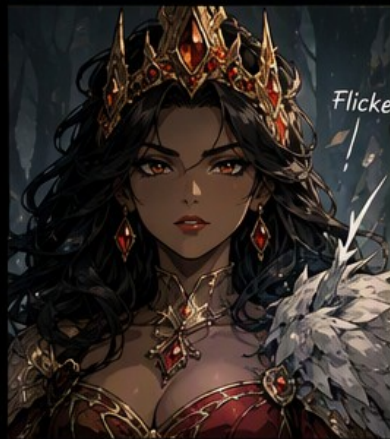
— NO RIDDLES.

ONLY RECORDS.

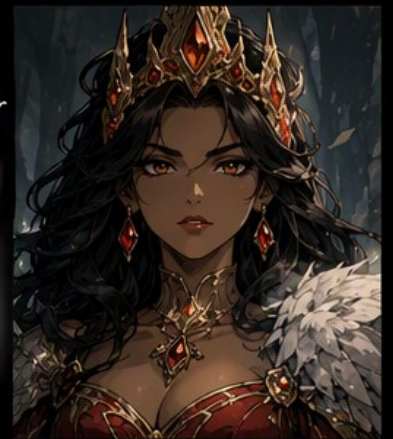
AND WHAT IS FORGOTTEN SHOULD SOMETIMES REMAIN SO.



THEN YOU KNOW WHAT WE'RE LOOKING FOR.



Flicker!



VERY WELL.

FOLLOW ME.



You
are not
properly
filed.



THE VERIDIAN
ARCHIVE.

EST. 3,412 AE

A REPOSITORY OF
ECHOES, LAWS,
AND SELECTIVE
MEMORIES.

EVERY CHAIN
HOLDS A RECORD.
EVERY RECORD,
A CONSEQUENCE.

SO WE
DON'T BORROW
HISTORY—

WE
ANSWER TO IT.

WELL
SAID.

CHOOSE
WISLY WHAT
YOU WAKE.

MAPS OF
CITIES THAT
NEVER WERE.

TREATIES
SIGNED IN
BLOOD OR
SILENCE.

NAMES
THAT ECHO—
THEN FADE.

THEN
LET'S FIND
WHAT DOESN'T
FADE.

COME.
THE STAIRS
ADJUST TO
INTENT.

AND SOME
TRUTHS...

ONLY REVEAL
THEMSELVES
ON THE WAY
DOWN.





FOUND
IN THE DEEP
STACKS.

FILE IS
OLDER THAN
THE FEED.



ALL
THAT'S LEFT
OF YOUR
PERSONAL
ARCHIVE.

OR WHATEVER
THE FEED
DIDN'T EAT.



...MY
NAME?



MM.

SEALED
BEFORE THE
BLACKOUT.
ACCESSED LONG
AFTER.

YOU WERE
IMPORTANT
ENOUGH TO
SAVE.



...

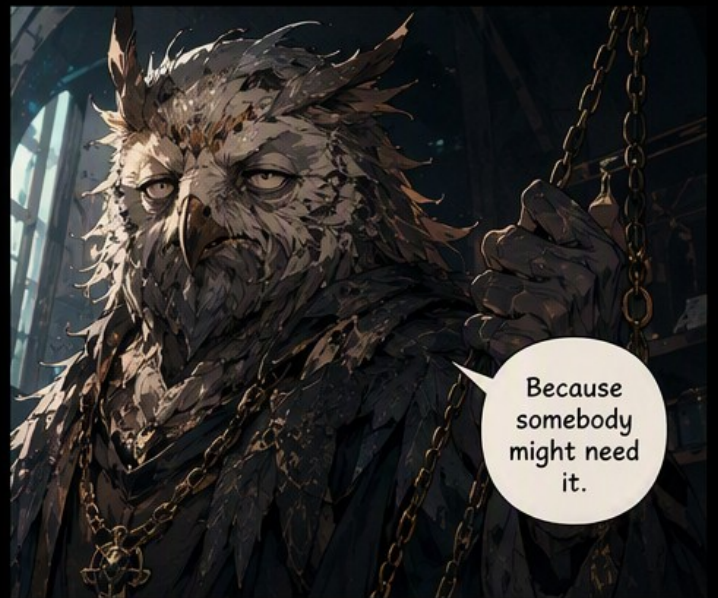


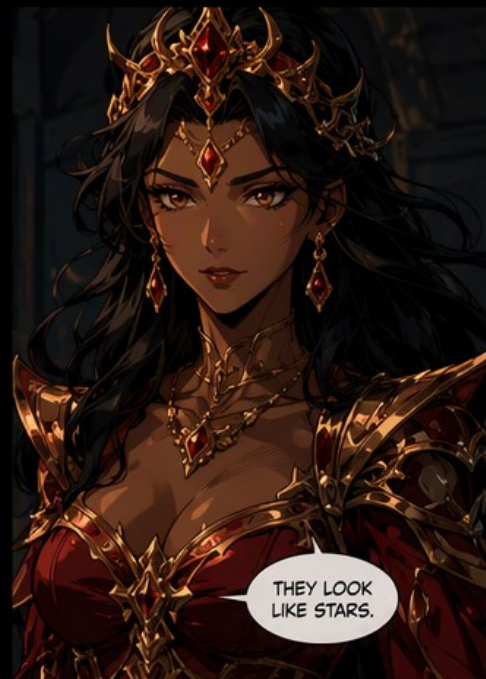
LOTS OF
PEOPLE WERE
IMPORTANT
ONCE.

FEW LEFT
ANYTHING
BEHIND.









SOME RECORDS
DO NOT BEGIN
WITH A NAME.

THEY BEGIN
WITH A WORD.



IT FADES.



SO I WRITE
IT AGAIN.



SOME DO
NOT NEED TO
BE FOUND.

THEY CONTINUE
ANYWAY.

